## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 1: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(d)** valued independence | She wanted to read herself. |
| 2 | **(a)** new and original | Another sense of the word. |
| 3 | **(c)** full of pride | He celebrates it. |
| 4 | **(d)** She saw her sincere wish | The wish was genuine. |
| 5 | **(a)** contrast | Old vs keen. |
| 6 | **(b)** natural beauty to cultural greatness | Land first, then wisdom and heritage. |
| 7 | **(a)** She treated her young granddaughter as a teacher | She accepted a teacher's authority. |
| 8 | **(c)** She said, "I will learn to read." | Comma before the quotation, quotes around speech. |
| 9 | **(c)** what is handed down from the past | Inherited traditions. |
| 10 | **(c)** another's happiness over her own wish | She funded a girl's marriage. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | She was old and had never studied (1), yet she faced the challenge and a young teacher (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | The young girl teaches the old woman (1). The old woman bows to the child (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Pride and love for the nation (1) and a wish to join in praise (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Delayed magazines created her need to learn (1). Village life shows how few girls studied then (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | She cried from helplessness (1). Her pain turned into a resolve (1). This led her to ask for lessons (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | She gave up her wish for a girl's wedding (1). Giving brought her happiness (1). The grandmother liked this message (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | It names the land as ours (1). It values shared heritage (1). It builds belonging (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Weak eyesight and slow memory (1). Fear of mocking (1). Lack of confidence (1). She overcame them with practice. | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | The grandmother said that she was learning to read (1). 'Am' becomes 'was' (1). The pronoun I becomes she (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Snow-capped peaks (visual) (1). Rivers like silver threads (simile and image) (1). Both create vivid pictures (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | The narrator's patience is key (1). Her role changes from child to teacher (1). The grandmother's effort is equal (1). Both gain respect (1). Learning is a shared journey (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Stanzas build on one theme (1). Refrain gives unity (1). Rhythm like a song (1). Repetition adds emphasis (1). The ending is an invitation (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | The grandmother missed school as a girl (1). She felt helpless as an adult (1). Learning gave her pride (1). Educated girls become independent (1). Society must offer opportunity (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** He wants to inspire others (1). The poem is a public song (1). Praise is a duty (1). Love is shared (1). Therefore the speaker is a guide (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

- Writing that **Sudha Murty** is the grandmother, or that the grandmother is the author. The narrator is the granddaughter (the author) who teaches her grandmother, who began learning at about **sixty-two**.
- Giving the wrong reason for the grandmother's illiteracy. In her childhood girls were not sent to school; do not say she was lazy or had no time.

- Missing the theme: the story is about **learning at any age** and the respect a teacher earns, not just 'a grandmother who reads a serial'. Name the serial (*Kashi Yatre*) and the goal (reading a novel) when asked for details.
- In 'Bharat Our Land', calling the poem sad or critical. Its mood is proud and celebratory; naming only 'rhyme' for devices instead of **refrain, personification (mountains guard her) and imagery**.
- Tense slips such as *'She learn to read at sixty-two'*; the narrative needs the simple past (**learnt**). Also confusing the teacher and pupil roles when writing the summary.
- Copying lines of the lesson as the answer. Write 2-mark answers as a point plus a reason (1 + 1), in your own words, and quote only the key phrase.

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 1: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** The novel was read by the grandmother. | Object becomes subject. |
| 2 | **(d)** elevated language and feeling | Lofty tone. |
| 3 | **(a)** old people cannot learn | A sixty-two-year-old learnt. |
| 4 | **(b)** but | But joins two clauses. |
| 5 | **(b)** peerless - unmatched | Peerless = unmatched. |
| 6 | **(c)** gave her focus and urgency | Goals create discipline. |
| 7 | **(c)** idiom | Its meaning is not literal. |
| 8 | **(b)** respect and devotion | Respect for a teacher; devotion to the land. |
| 9 | **(d)** It showed respect for knowledge, not age | She honoured her teacher. |
| 10 | **(b)** had | Third conditional uses 'had'. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | She cared for another person's happiness (1) more than her own pilgrimage (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Natural beauty (1) and cultural wisdom (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | That knowledge is to be respected (1) and a teacher may be younger than the learner (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | It is personification (1). Mountains do an action of living guards (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | At first granddaughter and listener (1). Then a teacher giving lessons (1). At the end a person honoured by her own learner (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Although she was old, she learnt to read (1). 'Although' adds a subordinate clause (1). The main clause is 'she learnt to read' (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | Personification: the Ganga sings (1). Simile: waves like music (1). Together they give life and sound (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** It shows seriousness (1). It shows she treated lessons as a duty (1). It helps explain her success (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Sight in mountains and rivers (1). Sound in the idea of songs (1). Feeling of pride (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** The narrator shows respect through teaching and receiving thanks (1). The poet shows respect through praise (1). Both are acts of gratitude (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Helpless at the serial (1). Determination to learn (1). Hard work and progress (1). Meeting the goal (1). Joy and gratitude (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Introduction (1). The grandmother's respect (1). The poet's respect for heritage (1). Why respect matters (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | The narrator's amused first reaction (1). Light moments with homework (1). Affectionate language (1). The role reversal (1). The happy ending (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Correct format with names (1). Grandmother's request (1). Narrator's doubt and consent (1). The first letters (1). Encouraging close (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

- Writing that **Sudha Murty** is the grandmother, or that the grandmother is the author. The narrator is the granddaughter (the author) who teaches her grandmother, who began learning at about **sixty-two**.
- Giving the wrong reason for the grandmother's illiteracy. In her childhood girls were not sent to school; do not say she was lazy or had no time.

- Missing the theme: the story is about **learning at any age** and the respect a teacher earns, not just 'a grandmother who reads a serial'. Name the serial (*Kashi Yatre*) and the goal (reading a novel) when asked for details.
- In 'Bharat Our Land', calling the poem sad or critical. Its mood is proud and celebratory; naming only 'rhyme' for devices instead of **refrain, personification (mountains guard her) and imagery**.
- Tense slips such as *'She learn to read at sixty-two'*; the narrative needs the simple past (**learnt**). Also confusing the teacher and pupil roles when writing the summary.
- Copying lines of the lesson as the answer. Write 2-mark answers as a point plus a reason (1 + 1), in your own words, and quote only the key phrase.

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## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 1: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** The woman whose dream came true is my grandmother. | Whose shows possession. |
| 2 | **(d)** ask others to read for her | That was her limit. |
| 3 | **(c)** stress devotion to the land | A refrain emphasises. |
| 4 | **(a)** the grandmother's steady practice | She kept working. |
| 5 | **(c)** warm and affectionate | A loving memory. |
| 6 | **(a)** personification | Rivers are said to sing. |
| 7 | **(a)** the grandmother would remain dependent | Her wish needed a teacher. |
| 8 | **(a)** noun meaning a long story | A book of fiction. |
| 9 | **(b)** a call to praise | An invitation. |
| 10 | **(b)** The grandmother began to learn at sixty-two | Age is a fact in the text. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Its refrain and rhythm suit group singing (1) and the praise is a shared feeling (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | She saw the grandmother's effort and humility (1). She learnt that determination matters more than age (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | It reinforces the poet's praise (1) and makes the poem musical (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | The story encourages gratitude to teachers (1). The poem encourages gratitude to the motherland (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | She chose Dassara as a deadline (1). The target kept her focused (1). She met it and felt proud (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | No other land equals her in beauty and wisdom (1). The statement shows deep love (1). It is an expression of patriotism rather than a comparison (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | It is a festival of learning (1). It was the deadline for the grandmother (1). It marks her success (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** The grandmother was older but honoured her teacher (1). She respected knowledge (1). Thus respect follows learning (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Mountains and rivers show strength and life (1). They are symbols of the nation (1). Nature and culture are joined (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Her determination (1). Her humility (1). Her love for learning, which is useful in life (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Greeting (1). The grandmother's example (1). The role of a teacher (1). Benefits of learning (1). Conclusion with call to action (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Before: depended on others (1). Felt helpless (1). After: read a novel herself (1). Gained confidence (1). Became an inspiration (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Mountains and rivers as natural gifts (1). Sages and wisdom as cultural gifts (1). Joined through the refrain (1). Personification adds warmth (1). The effect is patriotic pride (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Title and author (1). Brief summary (1). Characters (1). Theme and style (1). Your recommendation (1). | 2+2+1 |

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